stopped his inquisition, released the suspects he arrested and expelled him from the area.[71]

Kramer hit back through the printing press. Within two years of his banishment, he compiled and published the *Malleus Maleficarum – The Hammer of the Witches*. This was a do-it-yourself guidebook to exposing and killing witches in which Kramer described in detail the worldwide conspiracy and the means by which honest Christians could uncover and foil the witches. In particular, he recommended the use of horrific methods of torture in order to extract confessions from people suspected of witchcraft, and was adamant that the only punishment for the guilty was execution.

Kramer organised and codified previous ideas and stories and added many details from his own fertile and hate-filled imagination. Relying on ancient Christian misogynist teachings like those of 1 Timothy, Kramer sexualised witchcraft. He argued that witches were typically female, because witchcraft originated in lust, which was supposedly stronger in women. He warned readers that sex could cause a pious woman to become a witch and her husband to become bewitched.[72]

An entire chapter of the *Hammer* is dedicated to the ability of witches to steal men's penises. Kramer discusses at length whether the witches are really able to take away the male member from its owner, or whether they are only able to create an illusion of castration in men's minds. Kramer asks, 'What is to be thought of those witches who in this way sometimes collect male organs in great numbers, as many as twenty or thirty members together, and put them in a bird's nest, or shut them up in a box, where they move themselves like living members, and eat oats and corn, as has been seen by many?' He then relates a story he heard from one man: 'When he had lost his member, he approached a known witch to ask her to restore it to him. She told the afflicted man to climb a certain tree, and that he might take which he liked out of the nest in which there were several members. And when he tried to take a big one, the witch said: You must not take that one; adding, because it belongs to a parish priest.'[73] Numerous notions about witches that are still popular today – for instance, that witches are predominantly women, that witches engage in wild sexual activities and that witches kill and mutilate children – were given their canonical form by Kramer's book.